

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC

STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE → STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL → LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED → INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION → MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP → ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE

STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE

PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE

LOWER PALAEOLITHIC

MIDDLE PALAEOLITHIC

UPPER PALAEOLITHIC

MESOLITHIC HANDAXE/CLEAVER FLAKES/PREPARED CORES BLADES/BONE/ART MICROLITHS MOBILE LANDSCAPES FLEXIBLE

TRANSITIONS ARE REGIONALLY STAGGERED; TOOL CHANGE IS NOT A



CHRONOLOGY / PHASE • PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE • Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared cores blades/bone/art microliths mobile landscapes flexible	MATERIAL / INSTITUTION • reduction wider symbolism diverse niches • Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.	IMPACT / LIMIT • PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE • Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared cores blades/bone/art microliths mobile landscapes flexible
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

01

STAGE 01 STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL ARCHIVE

STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL ARCHIVE

RAW-MATERIAL NODULE

CORE REDUCTION

TOOL USE

DISCARD SOURCE DISTANCE SKILL/PLANNING EDGE DAMAGE ACTIVITY AREA

ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT

BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

A LABELLED TOOL WITHOUT CONTEXT CANNOT ESTABLISH AGE, SPECIES



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY • RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning edge damage activity area • ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM • A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway. • RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning edge damage activity area	DEBATE / LEGACY • ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE • A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

02

STAGE 02 LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED

LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED

LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC BIFACES, CLEAVERS FLAKE TOOLS BLADES

TECHNOLOGY RECORDS CHOICES; OLDER TECHNIQUES MAY PERSIST BESIDE NEWER

GROWTH HAFTED COMPOSITES QUARTZITE COMMON RAW-MATERIAL ECONOMY SYMBOLIC EVIDENCE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools prepared-core planning bone/ornament growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.	DEBATE / LEGACY growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses
POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools prepared-core planning bone/ornament growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools prepared-core planning bone/ornament	DEBATE / LEGACY Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY • LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools prepared-core planning bone/ornament • growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM • Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones. • LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools prepared-core planning bone/ornament	DEBATE / LEGACY • growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses • Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

03

STAGE 03 INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION, SITE, SIGNIFICANCE

INDIAN SITE MAP

REGION, SITE, SIGNIFICANCE

SOAN VALLEY

RIVER-TERRACE LITHICS AND SEQUENCE DEBATES

BELAN VALLEY

LONG PREHISTORIC SEQUENCE TOWARD FOOD PRODUCTION

SHELTERS/ROCK ART

MESOLITHIC EVIDENCE

NORTH-WEST: Soan valley → river-terrace lithics and sequence debates



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY • NORTH-WEST: Soan valley → river-terrace lithics and sequence debates • NORTH: Belan valley → long prehistoric sequence toward food production • CENTRAL: Bhimbetka → shelters/rock art	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM • Adangarh → Mesolithic evidence • WEST: Bagor → Mesolithic settlement, subsistence and domestication debate • GANGA PLAIN: Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, Damdama → burials and sedentism	DEBATE / LEGACY • SOUTH: Attirampakkam → early Acheulian and Middle Palaeolithic chronology • DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal → quarry, factory and landscape organisation
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal — quarry, factory and landscape organisation.

04

STAGE 04 MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP

MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP

SEASONAL RESOURCES

MOVEMENT SCHEDULE

CAMP TYPE

TOOL KIT

SHARING NETWORK GAME, FISH, PLANTS BASE/SPECIAL CAMP HEARTHS PORTABLE/COMPOSITE

REPEATED OCCUPATION AND STORAGE MAY INCREASE WITHOUT FULL FARMING

BURIALS SHOW TREATMENT OF PERSONS; RANK NEEDS PATTERNED UNEQUAL



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY • SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game, fish, plants base/special camp hearths portable/composite • Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM • Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence. • SEASONAL RESOURCES → MOVEMENT SCHEDULE → CAMP TYPE → TOOL KIT → SHARING NETWORK game, fish, plants base/special camp hearths portable/composite	DEBATE / LEGACY • Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages. • Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

05

STAGE 05 ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC LIFE: INFERENCE LADDER

ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC LIFE

INFERENCE LADDER

PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT SECURE

IMAGE, TECHNIQUE, RELATIVE SEQUENCE AND DEMONSTRATED ASSOCIATION PROBABLE

HUNTING, DANCE, GROUP ACTION, ANIMALS AND CHANGING STYLE UNCERTAIN

EXACT MYTH, DEITY, ARTIST IDENTITY OR DIRECT RITUAL MEANING

ART EXPANDS BEHAVIOURAL EVIDENCE BUT IS NOT ILLUSTRATED SCRIPTURE.

SOURCE / MATERIAL • PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT secure: image, technique, relative sequence and demonstrated association probable: hunting. • dance, group action, animals and changing style uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning	METHOD / DEBATE • VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture. • PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT secure: image, technique, relative sequence and demonstrated association probable: hunting.	HISTORICAL RESULT • dance, group action, animals and changing style uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning • VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.
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MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

06

STAGE 06 MESOLITHIC TRANSITION: ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

MESOLITHIC TRANSITION

ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES SMALL GAME/FISH/PLANT NICHES +

UNEVEN PATHWAYS TOWARD NEOLITHIC PRODUCTION



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY • HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps • selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM • HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps • selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production	DEBATE / LEGACY • HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps • selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

07

STAGE 07 LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

SPARSE FOSSILS + DISTURBED SITES + BROAD TOOL LABELS

FALSE SHORTCUTS

ONE TOOL

ONE PEOPLE

DATE CONTEXTS, RECONSTRUCT REDUCTION SEQUENCE, COMPARE REGIONS, STATE CONFIDENCE

REFINED CHRONOMETRY AND LANDSCAPE STUDY CAN REVISE EARLY DATES.

INDIAN PREHISTORY IS A MOSAIC OF LONG CONTINUITY AND

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY • PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations • FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people • innovation = migration	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM • burial = hierarchy • RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence • Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.	DEBATE / LEGACY • VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.
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MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

08

STAGE 08 STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

DEFINE PHASE

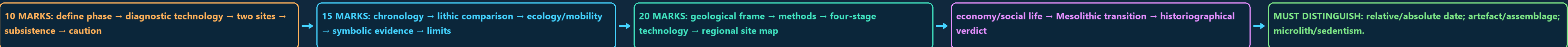
DIAGNOSTIC TECHNOLOGY

TWO SITES

15 MARKS

LITHIC COMPARISON

SYMBOLIC EVIDENCE



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY • 10 MARKS: define phase → diagnostic technology → two sites → subsistence → caution • 15 MARKS: chronology → lithic comparison → ecology/mobility → symbolic evidence → limits	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM • 20 MARKS: geological frame → methods → four-stage technology → regional site map • economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict	DEBATE / LEGACY • MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism. • CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH • Mini-timeline • 1. Snapshot & core idea • 2. Key classification / data • 3. Study links	ADVANCED DEBATE • 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims) • 5. UPSC Traps • 6. Current link • 7. Mains angles	LEGACY / NUANCE • She discusses Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic sites separately, including tool types and manufacturing contexts. • Isampur is treated as a centre of stone-tool manufacture. • Middle Palaeolithic discussions include Attirampakkam and the Levallois technique. • Mesolithic levels can yield animal bones and pottery; some claims of domesticated cattle, sheep, goat, dog and pig are questioned.
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OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.